



The Morning Brief

MAY 29, 2026

Framework Bid

*Fresh S&P and Nasdaq records on AI earnings momentum and reported US-Iran 60-day extension;
hot 3.8% headline PCE absorbed without a meaningful tape reaction.*

SPY	BRENT (BNO)	AMD	BITCOIN (IBIT)	FEAR & GREED
\$754.60 ↑0.55%	\$51.33 ↑0.37%	\$518.09 ↑4.55%	\$41.56 ↓2.10%	23 · Extreme Fear

SECTION 01

Markets — Records Reload Despite a 3.8% PCE Headline

FRESH S&P AND NASDAQ ATHS ON AI EARNINGS MOMENTUM — TAPE ABSORBS THE HOTTEST HEADLINE PCE SINCE MID-2023 WITHOUT A MEANINGFUL REACTION

Thursday’s session resolved the price-sentiment divergence the prior brief flagged in favor of the tape rather than the sentiment gauge. SPY closed at \$754.60 (↑0.55%) on a fresh all-time high, the Nasdaq proxy at \$735.60 (↑0.84%) also on a fresh record, and the Russell 2000 at \$292.03 (↑0.57%); the Dow lagged at \$507.05 (↑0.03%) under industrial weight. The macro event was the 8:30 AM ET Personal Income and Outlays release: per the BEA, headline PCE came in at 3.8% year over year — the highest reading in nearly three years per CNBC — while core PCE printed in line at 3.3%. Despite the headline heat, sector breadth was constructive in a notable rotation: Healthcare (XLV ↑1.40%) and Tech (XLK ↑1.31%) led, while Utilities (XLU −1.13%), Real Estate (XLRE −0.49%), and Financials (XLF −0.29%) lagged. UVXY closed at \$29.49 (−2.96%), TLT added 0.52% to \$85.74, and Fear & Greed barely moved from Wednesday’s extreme to 23 (Extreme Fear). The gap between record-tape and Extreme-Fear sentiment is now structural rather than transient.

DELL’S AFTER-HOURS PRINT IS THE SETUP FOR FRIDAY’S OPEN — IOWN AI INFRASTRUCTURE SLEEVE HAS A MATERIAL READ-THROUGH ACROSS LRCX, TSM, MRVL, CRDO, VST, NEE, AND HUT

Dell Technologies reported fiscal Q1 2027 results after Thursday’s close: record revenue of \$43.8 billion (↑88% year over year), AI-Optimized Servers revenue of \$16.1 billion (↑757%), \$24.4 billion in AI orders booked in the quarter, and a \$51.3 billion AI server backlog, per Dell’s 8-K and CNBC coverage. Management raised FY27 AI server revenue guidance to \$60 billion and full-year total revenue to \$165–\$169 billion, up from a prior range near \$138–\$142 billion. Dell shares moved approximately 39% higher in after-hours per CNBC. The Pentagon’s \$9.7 billion productivity-services

contract previously announced reinforced the read. The translation to the IOWN sleeve is broad: the wafer-fab equipment line (LRCX), the foundry and back-end (TSM, TEL), the connectivity layer (CRDO, MRVL), and the data-center power complex (VST, NEE, HUT) all sit at the bottleneck of a \$60-billion-per-year AI server build. Inside the data drop, AMD already pre-translated the read with a ↑4.55% session to \$518.09; LRCX held the prior-session range at \$318.00; CRDO closed at \$222.35 (↑0.51%) into its June 1 fiscal Q4 print. Snowflake (non-IOWN) added ↑36.5% per CNBC on a separate \$6 billion AWS multi-year commitment alongside an earnings beat — the AI capex cycle

delivered two single-stock confirmations on the same session.

The physical world matters.

CRYPTO SLEEVE DIVERGED FROM THE EQUITY BID — IBIT — 2.10%, ETHA —1.91% AS ETF FLOWS REVERSED

The IOWN digital ETF line decoupled from the broader risk-on session. IBIT closed at \$41.56 (–2.10%) and ETHA at \$15.19 (–1.91%), with Benzinga reporting a \$527 million outflow from BlackRock’s IBIT and JPMorgan analysts characterizing the move as a cooling of the “debasement trade” following the dollar’s recent stabilization. On the operating side, COIN gained 4.87% to \$182.25 on the Standard Chartered global fiat partnership headline, and HOOD surged 11.29% to \$84.84 on agentic-AI and Trump-Account product announcements — the equity expressions of crypto infrastructure outperformed the asset itself. The divergence is

consistent with a market trading the rate-and-inflation regime through equity earnings cyclicals rather than through bitcoin-as-debasement.

S&P 500 · NASDAQ (THU)	SPY \$754.60 ↑0.55% ATH · QQQ \$735.60 ↑0.84% ATH
SECTOR LEADERS	XLV ↑1.40% · XLK ↑1.31% · XLY ↑0.42%
SECTOR LAGGARDS	XLU ↓1.13% · XLRE ↓0.49% · XLF ↓0.29%
DELL (AH PER CNBC)	Up ~39% AH · AI rev ↑757% · FY27 AI guide raised to \$60B
PCE (BEA, APRIL)	Headline 3.8% YoY · Core 3.3% in line · Highest headline since mid-2023 per CNBC
CARSON'S ACTIVE LEVEL	SPY \$645.80 support · Untouched (Thu low \$749.23)
FEAR & GREED	23 · Extreme Fear · Diverges from ATH tape

A tape that absorbs a 3.8% PCE print and prints fresh records on AI capex confirmation is a tape trading the cycle, not the inflation regime. The committee’s positioning — AI infrastructure, energy value, and physical-world industrials — sits at the intersection of both stories: it benefits if the AI thesis extends, and its dividend backbone provides ballast if the rate regime tightens further.

Research Reveals Opportunities.

Geopolitics

FROM “UNRAVELLING” TO “FRAMEWORK CLOSE” IN 24 HOURS — A REPORTED 60-DAY CEASEFIRE EXTENSION TENTATIVELY AGREED PENDING TRUMP’S SIGNOFF

The narrative shift inside Thursday’s session was material. Reuters reported a tentative agreement to extend the current ceasefire for a further 60 days and allow vessel traffic to flow through the Strait of Hormuz while negotiators address the remaining clauses. President Trump has not yet approved the agreement, per the same coverage, and the White House declined to comment. Vice President Vance characterized the diplomatic posture as close but not yet finalized, per Reuters, noting that ceasefires of this nature tend to feature periodic flare-ups. Earlier in the session, the US military denied separate Iranian claims that a US aircraft was downed near Bushehr, per Reuters. The day prior had been characterized as the framework “unravelling” under active strike exchanges; the headline trajectory reversed materially inside a single session. For the energy complex, the price reaction was unidirectional: oil moved roughly 5% lower intraday Thursday on the reopening reports per multiple outlets before stabilizing into the close (WTI -0.19% on USO at \$130.78; Brent ↑0.37% on BNO at \$51.33). Gold reversed Wednesday’s slide with GLD ↑1.05% to \$412.77 as the dollar headed for a weekly loss per Reuters, though the metal remains on track for its third consecutive monthly decline.

THE IOWN ENERGY SLEEVE IS NOW POSITIONED AGAINST A BINARY — A SIGNED FRAMEWORK COMPRESSES THE WAR PREMIUM; A FAILED SIGNOFF RE-PRICES THE TAIL WITH NO EQUIVALENT DEFENSE BID ON THURSDAY’S TAPE

The energy sleeve’s Thursday print sat against the framework-close narrative rather than against the strike exchanges: XLE essentially flat at -0.07%, VLO ↑1.88% to \$244.85, CVX ↑0.35% to \$183.03, CNX ↑0.56% to \$33.93, and OKE -1.35% to \$87.02 — a tape consistent with the market pricing the deal as more likely than not while not unwinding the entire structural premium. Defense did not bid back the difference: LMT ↑1.14% to \$537.21 and GD ↑1.83% to \$348.96 carried modestly higher on names with their own catalysts (per Yahoo, GD outperformed the broader market on session) rather than on hedge demand. The Brent strip remains structurally elevated relative to the pre-conflict baseline despite the deal optimism, consistent with the prior brief’s observation that supply chains have been permanently rerouted and Hormuz operates under a different risk regime.

If the signoff materializes, the war-risk premium tends to unwind further; if the framework falls back into strike-and-counter-strike, the energy sleeve would re-price toward the Wednesday extreme. Either path is consistent with the sleeve’s construction around constrained capacity rather than the escalation path itself.

FRAMEWORK STATUS	60-day extension tentatively agreed per Reuters · Trump signoff pending
VANCE POSTURE	Close but not yet finalized · Flare-ups characterized as expected
OIL (THU)	Down ~5% intraday on reopening reports · USO \$130.78 ↓0.19% · BNO \$51.33 ↑0.37%
GOLD · DOLLAR	GLD ↑1.05% to \$412.77 · Dollar heading for weekly loss per Reuters
IOWN ENERGY (THU)	VLO ↑1.88% · CVX ↑0.35% · CNX ↑0.56% · OKE ↓1.35%
DEFENSE (THU)	LMT ↑1.14% · GD ↑1.83% · No clear hedge bid

On Our Radar

1. Dell's blowout is the AI capex confirmation point the prior brief flagged as needed to close the price-sentiment gap. A \$51.3 billion AI server backlog, \$24.4 billion in Q1 AI orders, and a raised FY27 AI revenue guide to \$60 billion (per Dell's 8-K and CNBC) supplies the second leg the Snowflake \$6 billion AWS commitment opened. The IOWN sleeve's direct read-throughs are LRCX (wafer-fab equipment for the memory and logic builds), TSM (foundry), MRVL and CRDO (connectivity), TEL (interconnect), NEE and VST (power), and HUT (compute). Pre-market action in the names will be the first read on whether Friday's open extends the leadership or compresses on a sell-the-news beat-already-priced response. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. The Iran framework appears materially closer than at any point this week — Trump's signoff is the binary catalyst into the weekend. Per Reuters, the proposed 60-day extension would allow free vessel passage through Hormuz while negotiators work the harder clauses. Vance's characterization of the posture as close but not yet finalized is consistent with the prior brief's observation that the MOU had stalled on a small number of outstanding clauses. A weekend signoff compresses Brent further and could unwind the residual war-risk premium across CVX, VLO, OKE, and CNX; a failure or another strike exchange would reverse Thursday's framework bid. Defense exposure (LMT, GD) retains its orthogonal-hedge role through either path. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. PCE at 3.8% headline — the highest since mid-2023 per CNBC — was absorbed without a meaningful tape reaction, but the rate path is structurally tighter.

Core printed in line at 3.3% per the BEA release. The CME FedWatch positioning into Warsh's first FOMC on June 16–17 sits near no-change consensus per Bitcoin News coverage, and a hot headline reinforces that base case. Today's economic calendar carries Fed Bowman at 9:10 AM ET and Philadelphia Fed President Paulson at 9:15 AM ET, with Chicago PMI at 9:45 AM ET (estimate 50.5 vs prior 49.2) — a sub-50 print would reintroduce the slowdown risk the AI-led tape has been ignoring. The dividend sleeve's cash-generative names (ADP ↑1.02%, SYK ↑0.55%, ABT ↑0.72%, GPC ↑0.87%) historically tend to hold up well in higher-for-longer regimes. *Avoid Erosion.*

4. HOOD ↑11.29% to \$84.84 on agentic-AI and Trump Accounts — a single-stock confirmation of the AI-as-distribution thesis inside financials.

Per Yahoo Finance coverage, the move was driven by product announcements around agentic-AI features and the Trump Accounts partnership. COIN added 4.87% on Coinbase's reported Standard Chartered global fiat partnership per Yahoo. The Q2 rebalance addition of HOOD into the growth sleeve has carried materially since reset; the read-through for the broader sleeve is that AI-product launches now act as standalone revaluation catalysts, not just narrative inputs. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

5. CRDO reports fiscal Q4 after Monday's close (June 1) — the next IOWN-side test of the AI connectivity cycle inside a tape now further extended on Dell's confirmation.

Per Yahoo and Marketbeat, consensus sits near \$1.03 normalized EPS and roughly \$430 million revenue against the company's prior \$425–\$435 million Q4 guide. CRDO closed Thursday at \$222.35 (↑0.51%); the session range spanned roughly 8% intraday (\$212.72–\$229.39), consistent with elevated option-implied volatility into the print. A clean beat with raised guide extends the leadership; a guide cut against the elevated multiple could produce an outsized reaction comparable to ABT's April pattern. *Think Like an Owner.*

6. Carson's active SPY \$645.80 support remains untouched as the index extends to fresh ATHs.

Thursday's SPY intraday low printed \$749.23 — well above the level. The gap between current price and Carson's retracement target has now widened materially over the recovery; the level remains the framework for any sustained downside scenario rather than an actionable near-term marker. Fear & Greed at 23 (Extreme Fear) into Friday's open is the inverse signal — positioning remains defensive against a tape that continues to extend. **The physical world matters.**

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